

The Bay of Pigs















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KENNEDY TAKES THE GLOVES OFF



"We do not intend to be lectured on 'intervention' by those whose character was stamped for all time on the bloody streets of Budapest . . .

"It is not the first time Communist tanks have rolled over gallant men and women . . .

"Cuba must not be abandoned to the Communists. And we do not intend to abandon it . . .

"I am determined upon our system's survival and success, regardless of the cost and regardless of the peril . . ."











































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The Bay of Pigs



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- 1,400 CIA trained ex-Cuban paramilitaries land (on Apr. 17/1961) in Cuba. These troops expect US naval and air support.
- Fearing international backlash, JFK decides to hold back the promised support. The invasion fails after 3 days and the paramilitaries are taken prisoner.

Bay of Reactions

- 📌 U.S. Ambassador Adlai Stevenson denied any involvement in the first wave of air strikes, stating before the United Nations, "These charges are totally false and I deny them categorically." Stevenson continued to promote a story of two Cuban planes that had reportedly defected to the United States, apparently unaware that they were in fact U.S. planes piloted by U.S.-backed Cuban pilots.
- 📌 Che Guevara sent a note to Kennedy. It read: "Thanks for Playa Girón. Before the invasion, the revolution was weak. Now it's stronger than ever".
- 📌 The US halted trade with Cuba 5 months later.